



What was the thinking behind changing Zomato's name to Eternal?

It's more of a cultural mission statement for us. We have to build an organisation that lasts as long as possible. Again, for organisations which last that long, it's not about the business you are in or will be in, since they (businesses) do become outdated in changing times. It's more about the culture and having a team that innovates. These things ensure (generation of) new ideas and outcomes to stay relevant. So, that is the mission statement message to the organisation that we are not about a particular business; rather, we are about being relevant to the constantly changing times.



Blinkit is today a benchmark for speed of delivery. Is food delivery amenable to further speed and efficiency?

A 30-minute food delivery was fast two years ago. In fact, it was the norm. And then came quick commerce and spoiled us. People now expect food also in 10-15 minutes. Right now, we don't have the answers for food delivery in that kind of time, but customers want it. We are looking at various ways to do it.



How much more can customers expect in terms of improvement?

I don't have a universal answer to this. For example, if you want a gourmet dish,

it will take time. There's no way we can give you a hot and fresh pizza or a gourmet pizza in five or 10 minutes. But if you want a coffee and a patty, we can get them to you in five minutes, or a sandwich and a coffee in five or may be 10 minutes. And as soon as the density goes up, we might be able to shrink time for more items than what we start with. That's why it's not going to be a universal answer.

Even in quick commerce, not everything can be in 10 minutes, right? Fashion, apparel, electronics and some of the larger goods will take more than that.



What is the long-term plan for the entertainment ticketing business that you acquired from Paytm?

We already had a dining out business and that is about people stepping out of home. We noticed that when people step out to go to a restaurant, they could watch a movie. Or, if they go to watch an IPL game, a visit to a restaurant follows. So, we wanted to combine all the going-out use cases, put them into one single app and make that the default going-out app.

That was the thinking with Dining Out—we had it in the main app (food app), but over time we wanted it to have a separate app and a use case. We don't believe in the super app concept and go for as many separate apps as we can. It made sense to collaborate with Paytm and bundle all these use cases into one. **BT**

A ROUGH RIDE

For Deepinder Goyal, the founder and CEO of Zomato, it has been a roller coaster ride ever since Zomato got listed in July 2021. From an offer price of ₹76 per share, the stock, at one point, plummeted to ₹47. It was trading around ₹202 on March 12, leaving decent money on the table for investors. The peak was ₹300-plus, towards the end of 2024. Reflecting on how much has changed over the last few years, Goyal says the listing has been a positive.

"As a privately held company, some investors want data daily or weekly and there is a lot of explaining that is done. With this quarter-to-quarter disclosure cycle, we can think long-term and take initiatives that will pan out much later," he says. Each of the businesses is uniquely different with technology playing a critical function.

Take Blinkit, where the consumer base is steadily increasing, thanks to success in food delivery that gives Zomato a better understanding of consumer behaviour and sharpens the offering. "It's a lot about how much demand there is for a particular item on an everyday basis. We have very small dark stores that cannot stock everything. They keep stuff that sells once or twice a day," says Goyal before adding that it is a very "layered sort of business." Estimates by research agencies suggest that it could be a \$40 billion market in 2030 from \$5-6 billion today.

According to Christy Joseph, equity research analyst at Geojit Financial Services, Zomato has done well to make the shift from a food delivery company to a set of well-diversified businesses. "Over the next two-three years, a major chunk of the revenue will come from quick commerce. Plus, they now have the entertainment ticketing business," he says, emphasising that Hyperpure (a platform to assist restaurants in food and non-food purchases) contributes 25-28% to the total revenue. Each of the businesses must be in the black, he says.

That said, the new structure chang-